GRT Seminar Spring 2026 – Potent Categorical Representations

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Abstract

This semester, the GRT Seminar will focus on potent categorical representations, following the 2026 ICM address of Nadler–Ben-Zvi (based on joint work with Stefanich). There are many open questions!

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1 (1/22) David Nadler – Introduction

We're going to start with the first page or so of the paper. The rough idea here is to instantiate some of the ideas in Constantin Teleman's ICM address.

1.1 Categorical representations

Our motivation for studying categorical representations comes from the following analogy.

If Γ is a finite group, then we look at the group ring $\mathbb{C}[\Gamma]$ We may think of this as a ring of distributions, with multiplication given by convolution. Studying representations of Γ corresponds to studying modules over $\mathbb{C}[\Gamma]$.

In general, if $\mathcal{C}$ is a symmetric monoidal (∞-)category, e.g. $(\mathsf{Vect}_{\mathbb{C}}, \otimes)$, we may consider an algebra object $A \in \mathcal{C}$. We can study the category of modules $\mathsf{Mod}_A(\mathcal{C})$.

We can specialize this very general framework to give a notion of categorical representations. Let G be a connected reductive group over $\mathbb{C}$.

Definition 1.1. A *categorical* G*-representation* is a (presentable) stable $\mathbb{C}$-linear ∞-category which is a module over $D(G)$, the derived ∞-category of D-modules on G. We'll write G-Cat for the ∞-category of categorical G-representations.

Remark 1.2. Morally, the reason we use D-modules here is because they quantize the cotangent bundle. The really important object is T^*G (with two moment maps $T^*G \rightrightarrows \mathfrak{g}^*$ corresponding to the left and right actions of G). Everything here is secretly symplectic!

Example 1.3. Let $G \curvearrowright X$. Then we get an action $D(G) \curvearrowright D(X)$. This really corresponds to the moment map $T^*X \to \mathfrak{g}^*$.

1.2 Categorical representations of $\mathbb{G}_m$

Let's see what happens when $G = \mathbb{G}_m$.

Theorem 1.4. *There is a monoidal equivalence* $D(\mathbb{G}_m) \simeq \mathsf{QC}(\mathbb{A}^1/\mathbb{Z})$.

Indeed, recall that a D-module on $\mathbb{G}_m$ comes with two pieces of data:

- An action of the Euler vector field $t\partial_t$, corresponding to the coordinate on $\mathbb{A}^1$.
- An action of t and t^{-1}, corresponding to translation-equivariance.

This correspondence sends the δ distribution at 1 to the structure sheaf.

Corollary 1.5. *There is an equivalence* $\mathbb{G}_m$-$\mathsf{Cat} \simeq \mathsf{QC}(\mathbb{A}^1/\mathbb{Z})$-$\mathsf{Mod}$.

Reasonable objects within $\mathsf{QC}(\mathbb{A}^1/\mathbb{Z})$-$\mathsf{Mod}$ have "singular support" in (the 2-shifted version of) $T^*(\mathbb{A}^1/\mathbb{Z})$. This translates into a notion of "position" and "momentum" for such objects.

Example 1.6. If we consider a point $\lambda \in \mathbb{A}^1/\mathbb{Z}$, the module category $\mathsf{QC}(\lambda)$ corresponds to

$$D_\lambda(\mathbb{G}_m) = \left\langle \mathscr{O}_{\mathbb{G}_m}, d - \frac{\lambda}{z} dz \right\rangle \subset D(\mathbb{G}_m).$$

Roughly: the position of a $\mathsf{QC}(\mathbb{A}^1/\mathbb{Z})$-module corresponds to the monodromy. This relates to Langlands parameters.

Momentum should correspond to "equivariant parameters." To capture this, we must work microlocally. This is the motivation for considering potent categorical representations.

1.3 Another motivation

Sufficiently dualizable 2-categories give rise to 3d TQFTs. One can obtain some 3d TQFTs by taking S^1-compactifications of 4d TQFTs, i.e. setting $Z_3(\mathrm{pt}) = Z_4(S^1)$. If Z_4 is pure gauge theory, Z_3 corresponds to considering gauge theory with classical fields G/G. Remember that G/G can be thought of as the free loop space $\mathscr{L}BG$. The "equivariant parameters" here live in the numerator G, while the "monodromies" / "G-representations" come from the denominator G.

1.4 Defining potent categorical representations

We can write $\mathsf{G\text{-}Cat} = 2\mathsf{IndCoh}(\mathsf{G}_{\mathrm{dR}})$. Thus a possible extension is:

Definition 1.7. Let $\mathsf{G\text{-}Cat}^{\mathrm{pot}} = 2\mathsf{IndCoh}(\mathsf{G}/\mathsf{G})^{\mathrm{Tate}}$.

This contains $\mathsf{G\text{-}Cat}$ as the full 2-subcategory set-theoretically supported at $1 \in \mathsf{G}$. There are other subtleties (e.g. shearing, genuine equivariance) that should appear. We end up with a theorem:

Theorem 1.8. *There is an equivalence* $\mathbb{G}_{\mathfrak{m}}\text{-}\mathsf{Cat}^{\mathrm{pot}} \simeq 2\mathsf{IndCoh}(\mathbb{A}^1/\mathbb{Z})$.

We may also define a Lie algebra version:

Definition 1.9. Let $\mathsf{G\text{-}Cat}^{\mathrm{pot,gr}} = 2\mathsf{IndCoh}(\mathfrak{g}/\mathsf{G})^{\mathrm{Tate}}$.

Our goal this semester is to understand these definitions and theorems.

2 (1/29) Samuel Mayonnaise – Loop Spaces and D-Modules

Our goal for today is to prove the following.

Theorem 2.1. *Let* X *be a smooth scheme. Then there is an equivalences*

$$\mathsf{D}(\mathsf{X}) \otimes \mathsf{k}[\mathfrak{u}, \mathfrak{u}^{-1}] \simeq \mathsf{IndCoh}(\mathcal{L}\mathsf{X})^{\mathrm{Tate}}.$$

The "Tate construction" here captures an S^1-localization. To understand the above statement, we will need to recall some relevant definitions.

2.1 Loop stacks

Let X be a derived stack, i.e. a (covariant) functor from derived commutative rings to spaces satisfying a sheaf condition.

Remark 2.2. There are many models for "derived commutative rings" that we can use. In characteristic zero we may model derived commutative rings by connective commutative differential graded algebras. In general we can work with simplicial commutative rings.

The *loop stack* of X is $\mathcal{L}\mathsf{X} = \underline{\mathrm{Hom}}(\mathsf{S}^1, \mathsf{X})$. Here S^1 is viewed as a derived stack by sheafifying the constant sheaf with value S^1. More generally, sheafifying constant sheaves gives a definition of the *Betti stack* of any topological space.

Remark 2.3. The simplicial perspective can be useful in understanding this. We may think of the Betti stack of S^1 as a coequalizer of $\mathrm{pt} \rightrightarrows \mathrm{pt}$. This corresponds to building up S^1 as a simplicial set with nondegenerate 0- and 1-simplices.

Example 2.4. If X is a Betti stack, then $\mathcal{L}\mathsf{X}$ is the Betti stack corresponding to the (topological) loop space of X.

Let's think of S^1 as a (homotopy) pushout:

$$\begin{tikzcd} \mathsf{S}^0 \arrow[r] \arrow[d] & \mathrm{pt} \arrow[d] \\ \mathrm{pt} \arrow[r] & \mathsf{S}^1. \end{tikzcd}$$

This allows us to write

$$\mathcal{L}\mathsf{X} = \underline{\mathrm{Hom}}(\mathrm{pt} \sqcup_{\mathsf{S}^1} \mathrm{pt}, \mathsf{X}) = \underline{\mathrm{Hom}}(\mathrm{pt}, \mathsf{X}) \times_{\underline{\mathrm{Hom}}(\mathsf{S}^0, \mathsf{X})} \underline{\mathrm{Hom}}(\mathrm{pt}, \mathsf{X}) = \mathsf{X} \times_{\mathsf{X} \times \mathsf{X}} \mathsf{X}.$$

Thus we may interpret $\mathcal{L}\mathsf{X}$ as the derived self-intersection of the diagonal of X. This suggests that D-modules may potentially appear, since the normal bundle of the diagonal is the tangent bundle of X.

Assuming X has affine diagonal, we may write

$$\mathcal{L}\mathsf{X} = \underline{\mathrm{Spec}}_{\mathscr{O}_{\mathsf{X}}}(\mathscr{O}_{\mathsf{X}} \otimes_{\mathscr{O}_{\mathsf{X}} \otimes \mathscr{O}_{\mathsf{X}}} \mathscr{O}_{\mathsf{X}})$$

where all operations here are implicitly derived.

2.2 Hochschild homology

Suppose $X = \operatorname{Spec} R$ is affine. Then

$$\mathscr{O}(\mathcal{L}X) = R \otimes_{R \otimes R} R = HC_*(R)$$

the *Hochschild chains* of R. The *Hochschild homology* $HH^*(R)$ is the homology of this complex. In general, Hochschild chains are a "derived version of the abelianization $R/[R, R]$"

Remark 2.5. When X is a topological space / Betti stack, we have $\mathscr{O}(X) = C^*(X)$. The above discussion roughly translates into something like $H^*(\mathcal{L}X) = HH_*(C^*(X))$, at least when X is simply connected (so the diagonal is affine).

Theorem 2.6 (Hochschild–Kostant–Rosenberg)**.** *Let R be a commutative algebra with $X = \operatorname{Spec} R$ smooth. Then there is an equivalence of dg-algebras $HC_*(R) \simeq \Omega^*_R = \operatorname{Sym}^* \Omega^1_R[1]$, the complex of differentials on R. Geometrically, this translates into $\mathscr{O}(\mathcal{L}X) \simeq \Omega^*_X$.*

Definition 2.7. Let $\mathbb{T}_X[-1]$ be the odd tangent bundle of X, i.e. $\underline{\operatorname{Spec}}_{\mathscr{O}_X} \operatorname{Sym}^* \Omega^1_X[1]$.

HKR can be interpreted as an equivalence $\mathscr{L}X \simeq \mathbb{T}_X[-1]$ for any smooth scheme X. David pointed out that this equivalence should be thought of as an exponential map $\mathbb{T}_X[-1] \to \mathscr{L}X$. For stacks, the above statement of HKR fails.

Example 2.8. For $X = BG$, the loop space $\mathcal{L}G$ is the adjoint quotient G/G. However, $\mathbb{T}_X[-1]$ is $\mathfrak{g}/G$, which is quite different.

2.3 (2/5) Samuel Mayonnaise – Continued

Let X be a smooth scheme. Recall from last time that $\mathcal{L}X = \operatorname{Hom}(S^1, X)$ is the *derived loop space* of X. (Here Hom indicates internal Hom.) We may also understand $\mathcal{L}X$ as a fiber product $X \times_{X \times X} X$. If $X = \operatorname{Spec} R$ is affine, then $\mathscr{O}(\mathcal{L}X) = R \otimes_{R \otimes R} R = HC_*(R)$, the Hochschild chains of R.

2.4 HKR

We'll review the statement of HKR again in more detail.

Definition 2.9. The *de Rham algebra* of X is $\Omega^*_X = \operatorname{Sym}^*_{\mathscr{O}_X} \Omega_X[1]$. The *odd tangent bundle* of X is $\mathbb{T}_X[-1] = \operatorname{Spec}_{\mathscr{O}_X} \Omega^*_X$.

The object $\mathbb{T}_X[-1]$ is a derived scheme. It consists of X together with "odd tangent vectors."

Theorem 2.10 (Hochschild–Kostant–Rosenberg)**.** *For a smooth scheme X, there is an equivalence $\mathcal{L}X \simeq \mathbb{T}_X[-1]$ (as derived schemes over X). Via this equivalence, the constant loops correspond to the zero section.*

Part of the idea here is that the "loops" in a scheme are all infinitesimal. When we go to stacks, there are more interesting global loops, so the theorem fails.

The statement of HKR is étale-local, so we can reduce to proving the theorem for $\mathbb{A}^n$. This is not too hard to do!

Example 2.11. Let $X = \mathbb{A}^n = \operatorname{Spec} k[x_1, \ldots, x_n]$, and write $R = k[x_1, \ldots, x_n]$. We want to compute $HH_*(R) = R \otimes_{R \otimes R} R$. There is a *Koszul resolution*

$$0 \longrightarrow \wedge^n (R \otimes R)^{\oplus n} \longrightarrow \ldots \longrightarrow \wedge^1 (R \otimes R)^{\oplus n} \longrightarrow R \otimes R \longrightarrow 0$$

of R, where:

- the resolution map $R \otimes R \to R$ is by $x_i \otimes 1 \mapsto x_i$ and $1 \otimes x_i \mapsto x_i$,
- the map $\wedge^1 (R \otimes R)^{\oplus n} \to R \otimes R$ sends the ith standard basis vector to $x_i \otimes 1 - 1 \otimes x_i$, and

- other maps are defined using alternating sums generalizing the above.

Let's call this complex K^* and compute $K^* \otimes_{R\otimes R} R$. We get

$$0 \longrightarrow \wedge^n R^{\oplus n} \longrightarrow \dots \longrightarrow \wedge^1 R^{\oplus n} \longrightarrow R \otimes R \longrightarrow R$$

where all differentials are 0. Then $HH_i(\mathbb{A}^n) = \wedge^i R^n = \Omega^i_{\mathbb{A}^n}$, and this upgrades to an isomorphism of complexes $HC_*(\mathbb{A}^n) \simeq \Omega^{-*}_{\mathbb{A}^n}$. Thus HKR holds for $X = \mathbb{A}^n$.

David and Yuji worked out on the board that, when we work on $\mathbb{A}^1$, the Koszul complex is

$$\mathscr{I}_\Delta \longrightarrow \mathscr{O}_{\mathbb{A}^1\times\mathbb{A}^1}.$$

Tensoring with $\mathscr{O}_\Delta$ gives

$$\mathscr{I}_\Delta/\mathscr{I}_\Delta^2 \xrightarrow{0} \mathscr{O}_\Delta.$$

Using $\mathscr{I}_\Delta/\mathscr{I}_\Delta^2 = \Omega_X$, we get a "coordinate–free" proof of HKR in this case.

2.5 Loop rotation

So far we have not encountered the de Rham differential. Where does this come from? How can we see it from the loop space perspective?

There's a natural action of $S^1 \curvearrowright \mathcal{L}X$ coming from the rotation action $S^1 \curvearrowright S^1$. This makes sense as an action of "group objects" or at the level of functors of points. Because S^1 is connected, every point of S^1 acts by "the identity" on $\mathcal{L}X$, but the action has interesting monodromy (by moving around S^1). In other words, the action corresponds to an interesting self-homotopy of the identity map $\mathrm{id} : \mathcal{L}X \to \mathcal{L}X$. To linearize this action, let $\Lambda = C_*(S^1) = k[\epsilon]/\epsilon^2$ (where $\deg \epsilon = -1$). Then $S^1 \curvearrowright \mathcal{L}X$ corresponds to a Λ-module structure on $\mathscr{O}(\mathcal{L}X)$.

Let's think about what this means. Here ϵ acts on $\mathscr{O}(\mathcal{L}X)$ by degree -1. We have $\epsilon^2 = 0$ (since S^1 has no higher homology). The fact that $S^1 \curvearrowright \mathcal{L}X$ is a group action corresponds to the Leibniz rule $\epsilon(fg) = (\epsilon f)g + f(\epsilon g)$. In other words, ϵ serves as a differential making $\mathscr{O}(\mathcal{L}X)$ into a cdga!

Theorem 2.12. *Under the HKR isomorphism, the loop rotation action $S^1 \curvearrowright \mathcal{L}X$ corresponds to the de Rham differential d on Ω^*_X.*

3 (1/12) Will Fisher – Tate Objects and D-Modules

Our goal for today is to discuss an equivalence

$$\mathsf{IndCoh}(\mathcal{L}X)^{\mathrm{Tate}} \simeq \mathscr{D}_X\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}.$$

Here X is a (not necessarily smooth) scheme.

Remark 3.1. We may understand the categories appearing here as the periodic cyclic homology of $2\mathsf{IndCoh}(X)$.

Remark 3.2. Recall that $\mathcal{L}X = X \times_{X\times X} X$. If X is smooth, then $\mathcal{L}X$ is "quasi-smooth," and the homological algebra here behaves nicely. "Quasi-smooth" may be understood as a derived analogue of the lci condition.

If $\mathcal{L}X$ is smooth with smooth diagonal, then $\mathcal{L}X$ is smooth. This is typically a stacky phenomenon, i.e. $\mathcal{L}BG = G/G$ is smooth.

3.1 S^1-invariants in HKR

In the previous talks we learned that, when X is a smooth scheme, there is an equivalence $\mathcal{L}X \simeq \mathbb{T}_X[-1] = \mathrm{Spec}_{\mathscr{O}_X} \Omega_X^{-*}$. There is a loop rotation action of S^1 on $\mathcal{L}X$. Under the above equivalence, this corresponds to the action of $C_{-*}(S^1) = k[\lambda]$ on Ω_X^{-*} induced by the de Rham differential. (Here $|\lambda = -1$, so $\lambda^2 = 0$.) How can we upgrade the HKR equivalence $\mathsf{QCoh}(\mathcal{L}X) \simeq \Omega_X^{-*}\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}$ to incorporate this $C_{-*}(S^1)$-action?

Let (C^*, d) be a dg k-module with S^1-action, i.e. $(C^*, d) \in \mathsf{QCoh}(BS^1)$. Descent along $\mathrm{pt} \to BS^1$ (i.e. comonadic Barr-Beck) gives an equivalence $\mathsf{QCoh}(BS^1) \simeq \mathscr{O}(S^1) \simeq C^*(S^1)$. By k-linear duality (or descent using !-functors), we may identify this further with $C_{-*}(S^1)\text{-}\mathsf{Mod} \simeq k[\lambda]\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}$. That is, we have an equivalence

$$\mathsf{QCoh}(BS^1) \simeq k[\lambda]\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}.$$

Taking invariants of objects of $\mathsf{QCoh}(BS^1)$ produces modules over $\mathscr{O}(BS^1) = C^*(BS^1) = k[u]$ (with $|u| = 2$). For $k[\lambda]/\lambda^2$-modules, "taking invariants" corresponds to taking Hom out of the trivial representation k. The resulting complexes have an action of $\mathrm{Hom}_{k[\lambda]}(k, k)$. It is a good exercise to compute that $\mathrm{Hom}_{k[\lambda]}(k, k) = C^*(BS^1) = k[u]$.

3.2 Why work with IndCoh?

When we pass from $k[\lambda]\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}$ to $k[u]\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}$, we send $k[\lambda]$ to k. Every object of $k[\lambda]\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}$ can be built as a colimit of copies of $k[\lambda]$. Thus the images of such objects are always torsion modules over $k[u]$. We can actually see that $k[\lambda]\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}$ can be identified with the (colimit-completion of the) category of u-torsion $k[u]$-modules.

We can fix things by working with ind-coherent modules over $k[\lambda]$. The category $\mathsf{IndCoh}(k[\lambda])$ is compactly generated by k. Thus we get $\mathsf{IndCoh}(k[\lambda]) \simeq \mathrm{End}_{k[\lambda]}(k)\text{-}\mathsf{Mod} \simeq k[u]\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}$. The Tate construction will serve as a generalization of this.

Example 3.3. The $k[u]$-module $k[u, u^{-1}]$ corresponds to the ind-coherent $k[\lambda]$-module built out of infinitely many shifts of $k[\lambda]$. Here the shifts are cooked up so that we have one copy of k (or $k \cdot \lambda$) in each degree, with the $k[\lambda]$-module structure sending odd degrees to the next even degrees. The "underlying module" of this is trivial, but it is still interesting as an ind-coherent module!

3.3 (2/19) Will Fisher – Continued

The speaker is posting his own notes online, so look at those for an alternative viewpoint.

Our goal is to show the following: for X a smooth underived scheme, we have

$$\mathsf{IndCoh}(\mathcal{L}X)^{\mathrm{Tate}} \simeq \mathcal{D}_X[u, u^{-1}]\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}.$$

Here u is a formal variable of degree 2.

3.4 The Tate construction

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a k-linear category with S^1-action. Then $\mathcal{C}^{S^1}$ is a module over $\mathsf{Mod}_k^{S^1}$ (considered with respect to the trivial S^1-action). We can write $\mathsf{Mod}_k^{S^1} = \mathsf{QC}(\mathrm{pt})^{S^1} = \mathsf{QC}(BS^1)$. This last category is $k[[u]]$-linear where $|u| = 2$, so $\mathcal{C}^{S^1}$ must also be $k[[u]]$-linear. We would like to "invert u on each Hom-space."

Definition 3.4. The *Tate construction* applied to $\mathcal{C}$ is

$$\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{Tate}} = \mathcal{C}^{S^1} \otimes_{k[[u]]} k((u)).$$

Remark 3.5. The 0-categorical analogue of the Tate construction is as follows. Take a chain complex $C^\bullet$ with S^1-action. Note that $C_{-\bullet}(S^1) = k[\lambda]$, so $(C^\bullet)^{S^1} = \mathrm{Hom}_{k[\lambda]}(k, C^\bullet)$. The result is linear over $k[[u]] = \mathrm{End}_{k[\lambda]}(k)$, and we can invert u to get the Tate construction $C^{\mathrm{Tate}}_{-\bullet}$.

If X is a reasonable compact space with S^1-action, then $C^\bullet(X)^{S^1} = C^\bullet_{S^1}(X)$. We can show that $C^\bullet(X)^{\mathrm{Tate}} = C^\bullet(X^{S^1})[u, u^{-1}]$.

Remark 3.6. Given a variety X with a function to $\mathbb{G}_m$, we get an S^1-action on $\mathsf{QC}(X)$. The Tate construction here gives a definition of the corresponding matrix factorization category.

Here's another way to define a "Tate construction."

Definition 3.7. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a compactly generated k-linear category, i.e. $\mathcal{C} = \mathsf{Ind}(\mathcal{C}^\omega)$. Suppose there is an S^1-action on $\mathcal{C}^\omega$ inducing $S^1 \curvearrowright \mathcal{C}$. Then define $\mathcal{C}^{\omega S^1} = \mathsf{Ind}((\mathcal{C}^\omega)^{S^1})$, and let the ω-*Tate construction* be

$$\mathcal{C}^{\omega\mathrm{Tate}} = \mathcal{C}^{\omega S^1} \otimes_{\mathsf{k}[[u]]} \mathsf{k}((u)).$$

Note that $\mathsf{Ind}((\mathcal{C}^\omega)^{S^1}) \neq \mathsf{Ind}(\mathcal{C}^\omega)^{S^1}$ in general, so the ω-Tate and Tate constructions do not agree in general. We'll see this in the next section.

3.5 The case $X = \mathrm{pt}$

To work out what happens for $X = \mathrm{pt}$, we need to understand the $\mathsf{k}[[u]]$-linearity on $\mathsf{QC}(\mathrm{pt})^{S^1} = \mathsf{QC}(BS^1)$. The affinization map $\pi : BS^1 \to \mathsf{Aff}(BS^1)$ gives an adjunction

$$\pi^* : \mathsf{QC}(\mathsf{Aff}(BS^1)) \rightleftarrows \mathsf{QC}(BS^1) : \pi_*.$$

We may rewrite this adjunction as

$$\mathscr{O}(BS^1)\text{-}\mathsf{Mod} \rightleftarrows \mathsf{k}[\lambda]\text{-}\mathsf{Mod} : \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathsf{k}[\lambda]}(\mathsf{k}, -).$$

The object $\mathsf{k} \in \mathsf{k}[\lambda]\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}$ is not compact, so π_* doesn't preserve colimits. In particular, this adjunction is not an equivalence.

Koszul duality tells us that π^* and π_* do restrict to equivalences $\mathsf{Coh}(BS^1) \simeq \mathsf{Perf}(\mathsf{k}[[u]])$. Equivalently, we get $\mathsf{Ind}(\mathsf{Coh}(BS^1)) \simeq \mathsf{Ind}\,\mathsf{Perf}(\mathsf{k}[[u]]) = \mathsf{k}[[u]]\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}$.[1]

Remark 3.8. Here's another way of understand what's going on. The category $\mathsf{k}[[u]]\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}$ has two "basic" compact objects: $\mathsf{k}[[u]]$ and k. The former object corresponds to the compact object $\mathsf{k}[\lambda] \in \mathsf{k}[\lambda]\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}$. The latter corresponds to $\mathsf{k} \in \mathsf{k}[\lambda]\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}$, which is not compact! However, if we replace $\mathsf{k}[\lambda]\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}$ by $\mathsf{Ind}(\mathsf{Coh}(BS^1))$, we are able to match up our compact objects.

This is analogous to the difference between $S^1 \curvearrowright \mathrm{pt}$ and $S^1 \curvearrowright S^\infty$ in genuine equivariant homotopy theory. We can understand this difference by looking at the S^1-fixed points of each. The differences between $\mathsf{k}[\lambda] \curvearrowright C^\bullet(\mathrm{pt})$ and $\mathsf{k}[\lambda] \curvearrowright C^\bullet(S^\infty)$ becomes more transparent in the world of Ind-coherent sheaves.

Let's think about the equivalence $\mathsf{Ind}(\mathsf{Coh}(BS^1)) \simeq \mathsf{k}[[u]]\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}$. The induced map $\mathsf{QCoh}(BS^1) \to \mathsf{k}[[u]]\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}$ is *not* given by the usual pushforward. Instead, we have to resolve a quasicoherent sheaf by perfect complexes and then push forward each perfect complex. The category $\mathsf{Perf}(BS^1) = \mathsf{Perf}(\mathsf{k}[\lambda])$ is generated by $\mathsf{k}[\lambda]$, and $\pi_*\mathsf{k}[\lambda] = \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathsf{k}[\lambda]}(\mathsf{k}, \mathsf{k}[\lambda]) = \mathsf{k}[[u]]/u$. Thus our equivalence sends $\mathsf{QCoh}(BS^1)$ to the category $(\mathsf{k}[[u]]\text{-}\mathsf{Mod})^{u\text{-nil}}$ of filtered colimits of torsion modules. This gives our desired description of the $\mathsf{k}[[u]]$-linear structure.

Corollary 3.9. $\mathsf{IndCoh}(\mathrm{pt})^{\mathrm{Tate}} = \mathsf{QCoh}(\mathrm{pt})^{\mathrm{Tate}} = 0$.

When we work with the ω-Tate construction, we get a more interesting answer.

Corollary 3.10. $\mathsf{IndCoh}(\mathrm{pt})^{\omega\mathrm{Tate}} = \mathsf{k}((u))\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}$.

Proof. We have

$$\begin{aligned}\mathsf{IndCoh}(\mathrm{pt})^{\omega S^1} &= \mathsf{Ind}(\mathsf{Coh}(\mathrm{pt})^{S^1}) \\ &= \mathsf{Ind}(\mathsf{Vect}^{S^1}_{\mathsf{k},\mathrm{fg}}) \\ &= \mathsf{Ind}(\mathsf{Coh}(BS^1)) \\ &\simeq \mathsf{k}[[u]]\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}.\end{aligned}$$

Tensoring over $\mathsf{k}[[u]]$ with $\mathsf{k}((u))$ gives $\mathsf{k}((u))\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}$. □

Remark 3.11. The big picture here: we started with "naïve S^1-equivariance" and then passed to "genuine S^1-equivariance" (by allowing an "S^1-fixed theory"). The Tate construction kills the original naïve S^1-equivariant theory and only remembers the "extra information" governing the fixed points.

[1] There is an unfortunate subtlety here: $\mathsf{IndCoh}(BS^1) \neq \mathsf{Ind}(\mathsf{Coh}(BS^1))$. Indeed, the Gaitsgory-type definition of $\mathsf{IndCoh}(BS^1)$ comes from descent, not "taking Ind of Coh." In fact, $\mathsf{IndCoh}(BS^1) = \mathsf{QCoh}(BS^1)$ by our above descent argument. We will ignore these issues and instead focus on $\mathsf{Ind}(\mathsf{Coh}(BS^1))$, which doesn't satisfy descent.

4 (2/26) Will Fisher – Continued

Recall that our goal is to show $\mathsf{Ind}(\mathsf{Coh}(\mathcal{L}X))^{\mathrm{Tate}} = \mathscr{D}_X\text{-}\mathsf{Mod} \otimes_k k[u, u^{-1}]$. We previously showed a $k[[u]]$-linear equivalence $\mathsf{Ind}(\pi_*|_{\mathsf{Coh}}) = \mathsf{Ind}(\mathrm{Hom}_{k[\lambda]}(k, -))$ from $\mathsf{Ind}(\mathsf{Coh}(k[\lambda]\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}))$ to $k[[u]]\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}$.

4.1 The local case

Let R be a k-algebra with S^1-action, i.e. an algebra object in $(k[\lambda]\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}, \star)$. Suppose that R is coherent as a k-module.[2] Then $S^1 \curvearrowright R$ gives an action $S^1 \curvearrowright \mathsf{Coh}(R)$. We may write $\mathsf{Coh}(R) = \mathsf{Mod}_R(\mathsf{Coh}(k))$ and

$$\mathsf{Coh}(R)^{S^1} = \mathsf{Coh}(R \rtimes k[\lambda]) = \mathsf{Mod}_R(\mathsf{Coh}(k[\lambda]))$$

where $R \rtimes k[\lambda] = R\langle\lambda\rangle / (\lambda^2, [\lambda, r] = \lambda \cdot r)$. Koszul duality gives a $k[[u]]$-linear equivalence $\mathsf{Coh}(R)^{S^1} R^{S^1}\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}(\mathsf{Perf}(k[[u]]))$. Now we need to understand how to compute $R^{S^1} = \mathrm{Hom}_{k[\lambda]}(k, R)$.

Suppose $R = (C^\bullet, d)$. Using the resolution of k by shifts of $k[\lambda]$ presented in Swapnil's talks, we get $R^{S^1} = (C^\bullet[[u]], d + u\lambda)$. Thus $\mathsf{Coh}(R)^{S^1} = \mathsf{Coh}(R^{S^1}) = \mathsf{Coh}((C^\bullet[[u]], d + u\lambda))$.

Remark 4.1. David stressed that the expression $u\lambda$ involves $u \in k[[u]] = C^\bullet(BS^1; k)$ and $\lambda \in k[\lambda] = C_\bullet(S^1; k)$. These live in Koszul dual spaces, and combining them gives something "dimensionless" / "natural" (in the same way that d is).

4.2 Proving the equivalence

Let's assume that our story works over a more general base. Let X be a scheme, and consider the map $p : \mathcal{L}X \to X$. Note that p is affine and $\mathscr{O}_{\mathcal{L}X}$ is coherent as an $\mathscr{O}_X$-module because

$$\mathscr{L}X = \mathbb{T}_X[-1] = \mathrm{Spec}_{\mathscr{O}_X} \Omega_X^{-\bullet},$$

Working locally and using the above results we get

$$\mathsf{Coh}(\mathscr{L}X)^{S^1} = (\Omega_X^{-\bullet})^{S^1}\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}(\mathsf{Coh}(X)) = (\Omega_X^{-\bullet}[[u]], u d_{\mathrm{dR}})\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}(\mathsf{Coh}(X)).$$

When we invert u, we get

$$\mathsf{Coh}(\mathscr{L}X)^{S^1} \otimes_{k[[u]]} k((u)) = (\Omega_X^{-\bullet}, d_{\mathrm{dR}})\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}(\mathsf{Coh}(X)) \otimes_k k((u)).$$

We'll call objects of $(\Omega_X^{-\bullet}, d_{\mathrm{dR}})\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}(\mathsf{Coh}(X))$ (coherent) Ω-modules. We can relate these to $\mathscr{D}$-modules using Ω-$\mathscr{D}$ duality. The moral is that, for a Lie algebra $\mathfrak{g}$, Koszul duality relates modules over the Chevalley–Eilenberg algebra $\wedge^\bullet \mathfrak{g}^*$ to modules over the universal enveloping algebra $\mathcal{U}(\mathfrak{g})$.

Remark 4.2. David gave a general idea for Koszul duality (originally due to Quillen): the classifying space of a based loop group is a formal neighborhood of the basepoint. In symbols, for $x \in X$, we should have $\hat{X}_x = B\Omega_x X$. If we specify $y \in \hat{X}_x$ which is "infinitesimally close" to x, then the Ω_x-torsor of paths from x to y is the universal Ω_x-torsor.

The above discussion fits into this paradigm: we can think of an odd shift of $\mathfrak{g}$ as $\hat{X}_x$. Taking End of the augmentation module gives $\mathrm{Sym}\,\mathfrak{g}$. Turning on the Chevalley–Eilenberg differential (on $\wedge^\bullet \mathfrak{g}^*$) deforms $\mathrm{Sym}\,\mathfrak{g}$ to $\mathcal{U}\mathfrak{g}$.

Following the above moral, we can think of $(\Omega_X^{-\bullet}, d_{\mathrm{dR}}) = \wedge_X^{-\lambda\vee}$, so we get a Koszul duality with $\mathscr{D}_X = \mathcal{U}(\chi)$. We note that ${}_{(\Omega_X^{-\bullet}, d_{\mathrm{dR}})}(\mathscr{O}_X) = \mathscr{D}_X$. Koszul duality gives

$$(\Omega_X^{-\bullet}, d_{\mathrm{dR}})\text{-}\mathsf{Mod}(\mathsf{Coh}(X)) = \mathsf{Perf}(\mathscr{D}_X^\bullet).$$

Taking Ind of both sides gives

$$\mathsf{Ind}(\mathsf{Coh}(\mathscr{L}X)^{S^1}) \otimes_{k[[u]]} k((u)) = \mathscr{D}_X\text{-}\mathsf{Mod} \otimes_k k((u)).$$

Remark 4.3. David gave the following teaser for next time. So far, given a scheme X, we have looked at $\mathbb{T}_X[-1]$ with the de Rham differential. This is Koszul dual to $T_X^*[2]$ with its symplectic form ω.

More generally, for a stack X, we should think of $T_X[-1]$ as the Lie algebra of the loop space $\mathscr{L}X$. We don't know what the correct dual to this is! Potent categorical representations should help us understand things away from the "identity section" of $\mathscr{L}X$.

[2] Otherwise one needs to use t-structures to fix things. See work of Preygel.

5 (3/5) Jacob Erlikhman – Potent $\mathscr{D}$-Modules versus Ordinary $\mathscr{D}$-Modules

Our goal is to discuss how some of the above results break down for stacks. We shall begin by reviewing some basic stack theory.

5.1 Classifying stacks

The classifying stack BG can be constructed as the geometric realization of the simplicial diagram

$$\ldots \mathsf{G}^2 \rightrightarrows \mathsf{G} \rightrightarrows \mathrm{pt}\,.$$

The maps here come from projections and multiplication maps. We can also think of BG as the sheafification of the naïve quotient $\mathsf{S} \mapsto \mathrm{pt}(\mathsf{S})/\mathsf{G}(\mathsf{S})$. Given a map $\gamma : \mathsf{S} \to \mathsf{BG}$, pulling back $\mathrm{pt} \to \mathsf{BG}$ gives a principal G-bundle $\mathsf{P} \to \mathsf{S}$. Thus maps to BG classify (and are classified by) principal G-bundles.

5.2 Quotient stacks

Quotient stacks X/G behave similarly. For instance, they are the geometric realization of the simplicial diagram

$$\ldots \mathsf{X} \times \mathsf{G}^2 \rightrightarrows \mathsf{X} \times \mathsf{G} \rightrightarrows \mathsf{X}.$$

We may also view X/G as the sheafification of $\mathsf{S} \mapsto \mathsf{X}(\mathsf{S})/\mathsf{G}(\mathsf{S})$.

Remark 5.1. One can construct a simplicial diagram $\mathsf{X}^\bullet$ for any space X (using the projection maps as natural maps). If we replace some factors by G and quotient the whole thing out by G, we get the diagram mentioned above. David suggested thinking of this as a "free G-resolution of X."

Example 5.2. If P is a principal G-bundle on X, then $\mathsf{P} = \mathsf{S} \times_{\mathsf{BG}} \mathrm{pt}$. We can compute

$$\mathsf{P}/\mathsf{G} = \mathsf{S} \times_{\mathsf{BG}} \mathrm{colim}_{\Delta^{\mathrm{op}}} \mathsf{G}^n = \mathsf{S} \times_{\mathsf{BG}} \mathsf{BG} = \mathsf{S}.$$

That is, quotienting a G-torsor by G gives the underlying space.

Example 5.3. For $\mathsf{H} \subset \mathsf{G}$ a subgroup, we have $\mathsf{G}\backslash(\mathsf{G}/\mathsf{H}) = \mathsf{BH}$.

Given any $\mathsf{S} \to \mathsf{X}/\mathsf{G}$, we get an induced map $\mathsf{S} \to \mathsf{BG}$, and hence a principal G-bundle $\mathsf{P} \to \mathsf{S}$. We let $\mathsf{P} \times^{\mathsf{G}} \mathsf{X} = \mathsf{S} \times_{\mathsf{BG}} \mathsf{X}/\mathsf{G}$. We can construct a cube

$$\begin{tikzcd}
 & \mathsf{X} \times^{\mathsf{G}} \mathsf{P} \arrow[rr] \arrow[dd] & & \mathsf{X}/\mathsf{G} \arrow[dd] \\
\mathsf{X} \times \mathsf{P} \arrow[ur] \arrow[rr] \arrow[dd] & & \mathsf{X} \arrow[ur] \arrow[dd] & \\
 & \mathsf{S} \arrow[rr] & & \mathsf{BG} \\
\mathsf{P} \arrow[ur] \arrow[rr] & & \mathrm{pt} \arrow[ur] &
\end{tikzcd}$$

and show that $\mathsf{X} \times^{\mathsf{G}} \mathsf{P} = (\mathsf{X} \times \mathsf{P})/\mathsf{G}$. By studying this cube we see that G-torsors on S correspond to G-torsors P on S together with:

- a section of $\mathsf{X} \times^{\mathsf{G}} \mathsf{P} \to \mathsf{S}$, or equivalently:
- a G-equivariant map $\mathsf{P} \to \mathsf{X}$.

Example 5.4. Let $\mathsf{X} = \mathbb{A}^1$ and $\mathsf{G} = \mathbb{G}_m$. Then $(\mathbb{A}^1/\mathbb{G}_m)(\mathsf{S})$ parametrizes line bundles $\mathscr{L}$ on S together with a choice of section $\sigma \in \mathsf{H}^0(\mathsf{X}, \mathscr{L})$. The data of the section may also be understood as a $\mathbb{G}_m$-equivariant map from $\mathscr{L}^\times$ to $\mathbb{A}^1$. Roughly, σ corresponds to $s \mapsto [\ell_s, \phi(\ell_s)] \in (\mathscr{L}^\times) \times^{\mathbb{G}_m} \mathbb{A}^1$, and the $\mathbb{G}_m$-equivariant map is ϕ.

5.3 Loops on BG

Let's compute $\mathcal{L}\mathsf{BG} = \mathrm{Map}(\mathsf{S}^1, \mathsf{BG})$. This has S-points $\mathrm{Map}(\mathsf{S} \times \mathsf{S}^1, \mathsf{BG})$. Because $\mathsf{S}^1 = \mathsf{B}\mathbb{Z}$, we have $\mathsf{S} \times \mathsf{S}^1 = \mathsf{S}/\mathbb{Z}$ (where the $\mathbb{Z}$-action on S is trivial). Thus S-points of $\mathcal{L}\mathsf{BG}$ correspond to G-torsors on $\mathsf{S}/\mathbb{Z}$, or equivalently $\mathbb{Z}$-equivariant G-torsors P on S. The data of each such object corresponds to a G-torsor on S together with a choice of automorphism $\mathfrak{a} : \mathsf{P} \to \mathsf{P}$.

Now let's consider the adjoint quotient G/G. This has S-points given by G-torsors P on S together with a G-equivariant map $\mathsf{f} : \mathsf{P} \to \mathsf{G}$. Given $\mathfrak{a} \in \mathrm{Aut}(\mathsf{P})$, we may define $\mathsf{f} : \mathsf{P} \to \mathsf{G}$ via $\mathfrak{a}(\mathsf{p}) = \mathsf{p}\mathsf{f}(\mathsf{p})$. One checks that $\mathfrak{a}$ is a bundle automorphism if and only if f is G-equivariant for the adjoint action. This construction is invertible, so we get an identification $\mathcal{L}\mathsf{BG} = \mathsf{G}/\mathsf{G}$.